MINISTRIES DEPARTMENTS AND CENTRAL SECRETARIAT

CONSTITUTION → BUSINESS RULES → UNITS → MINISTER/SECRETARY → SECRETARIAT → HIERARCHY → COORDINATION → AGENCIES → ACCOUNTABILITY → PYQS → SYNTHESIS

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW ◆ SUBORDINATE EXTRA ★ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g3 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

00 STAGE 00 — CONSTITUTIONAL ROOT AND THE OPERATING CHAIN

CONSTITUTIONAL ROOT AND THE OPERATING CHAIN · ROOT QUESTION · HOW DOES PARLIAMENTARY EXECUTIVE AUTHORITY BECOME ORGANISED GOVERNMENTAL ACTION? · ARTICLES 73 + 74 --+-- UNION EXECUTIVE FIELD AND · +-- POLITICAL AUTHORITY REMAINS CONSTITUTION-BOUNDED · ARTICLE 77 ---------- +-- ACTION IN PRESIDENT'S NAME AND AUTHENTICATION · +-- ARTICLE 77(3) BUSINESS-ALLOCATION AND TRANSACTION RULES · ARTICLE 78 ---------- PM COMMUNICATION AND INFORMATION DUTIES TO

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- ROOT QUESTION
- How does parliamentary executive authority become organised governmental action?

POWER / PROCEDURE
- ARTICLES 73 + 74 --+-- Union executive field and ministerial advice
- +-- political authority remains Constitution-bounded

CHECK / LIMIT
- ARTICLE 77 ----------+-- action in President's name and authentication
- +-- Article 77(3) business-allocation and transaction rules

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- ARTICLE 78 ---------- PM communication and information duties to President
- Ministerial direction → Secretariat advice/process → agency delivery → accountability.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: A ministry joins democratic authority, ministerial responsibility and permanent expertise, while its effectiveness depends on aligning policy, finance, personnel, coordination and accountability Applied here to constitutional root and the operating chain.

01 STAGE 01 — AOB AND TOB: JURISDICTION BEFORE PROCEDURE

AOB AND TOB · JURISDICTION BEFORE PROCEDURE · ARTICLE 77(3) · ALLOCATION OF BUSINESS RULES TRANSACTION OF BUSINESS RULES WHO · TRAP RAIL · ARTICLE 309 · SCHEDULE CAN CHANGE · STATUTE STILL CONTROLS.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
ARTICLE 77(3)	TRAP RAIL	schedule can change	Allocation supplies jurisdiction; transaction supplies procedure and collective discipline.
ALLOCATION OF BUSINESS RULES TRANSACTION OF BUSINESS RULES who handles what how a proposal is decided ministry/department +	AoB != ToB	statute still controls.	
subjects disposal + consultation + escalation lawful owner + lawful decision route	both != Article 309	ANSWER STRIP	

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- ARTICLE 77(3)
- ALLOCATION OF BUSINESS RULES TRANSACTION OF BUSINESS RULES who handles what how a proposal is decided ministry/department +
- subjects disposal + consultation + escalation lawful owner + lawful decision route

POWER / PROCEDURE
- TRAP RAIL
- AoB != ToB
- both != Article 309

CHECK / LIMIT
- schedule can change
- statute still controls.
- ANSWER STRIP

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- Allocation supplies jurisdiction; transaction supplies procedure and collective discipline.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Articles 74, 75, 77 and 88 connect advice, responsibility, business rules and parliamentary participation, thereby linking Union administration to democratic accountability Applied here to aob and tob: jurisdiction before procedure.

02 STAGE 02 — INSTITUTION MAP: POLITICAL HEAD TO FIELD DELIVERY

INSTITUTION MAP · POLITICAL HEAD TO FIELD DELIVERY · SECRETARIAT POLITICAL BROAD ALLOCATED POLICY/LAW/BUDGET CHARGE UNIT SUBJECT UNIT · ATTACHED OFFICE SUBORDINATE OFFICE FIELD/DIRECTORATE TECHNICAL LEAD EXECUTION/SERVICE TERRITORIAL · SEPARATE LEGAL FORMS STATUTORY BODY · AUTONOMOUS BODY · TRAP ADMINISTRATIVE ASSOCIATION DOES NOT ERASE THE SOURCE INSTRUMENT

PORTFOLIO → MINISTRY → DEPARTMENT → SECRETARIAT political broad allocated policy/law/budget charge unit subject unit

ATTACHED OFFICE SUBORDINATE OFFICE FIELD/DIRECTORATE technical lead execution/service territorial chain → SEPARATE LEGAL FORMS statutory body → autonomous body

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- PORTFOLIO → MINISTRY → DEPARTMENT → SECRETARIAT political broad allocated policy/law/budget charge unit subject unit coordination/memory
- ATTACHED OFFICE SUBORDINATE OFFICE FIELD/DIRECTORATE technical lead execution/service territorial chain

POWER / PROCEDURE
- SEPARATE LEGAL FORMS statutory body
- autonomous body

CHECK / LIMIT
- TRAP administrative association does not erase the source instrument or statutory independence.
- PORTFOLIO → MINISTRY → DEPARTMENT → SECRETARIAT political broad allocated policy/law/budget charge unit subject unit coordination/memory

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- ATTACHED OFFICE SUBORDINATE OFFICE FIELD/DIRECTORATE technical lead execution/service territorial chain
- SEPARATE LEGAL FORMS statutory body

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The delivery chain runs from ministerial policy through Secretariat coordination to directorates and field agencies, while feedback and accountability must travel back upward Applied here to institution map: political head to field delivery.

03 STAGE 03 — MINISTER, MINISTER OF STATE AND SECRETARY

MINISTER, MINISTER OF STATE AND SECRETARY · POLITICAL EXECUTIVE · CABINET MINISTER · PORTFOLIO LEADERSHIP, CABINET PARTICIPATION, PARLIAMENT. · MINISTER OF STATE · INDEPENDENT CHARGE OR ASSIGNED ASSISTANCE, AS FORMALLY ALLOCATED. · PERMANENT EXECUTIVE · ADMINISTRATIVE HEAD + PRINCIPAL OFFICIAL ADVISER + TRANSACTION COMPLIANCE.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
POLITICAL EXECUTIVE	Secretary → administrative head + principal official adviser + transaction compliance.	oral direction	Responsive neutrality joins lawful democratic control to professional institutional memory.
Cabinet Minister → portfolio leadership, Cabinet participation, Parliament.	PRODUCTIVE RELATION elected priority → candid options/legality → recorded decision → loyal implementation.	short tenure	
Minister of State → independent charge or assigned assistance, as formally allocated.	FAILURE BRANCHES politicised advice	hidden responsibility.	
PERMANENT EXECUTIVE	bureaucratic veto	ANSWER STRIP	

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- POLITICAL EXECUTIVE
- Cabinet Minister → portfolio leadership, Cabinet participation, Parliament.
- Minister of State → independent charge or assigned assistance, as formally allocated.
- PERMANENT EXECUTIVE

POWER / PROCEDURE
- Secretary → administrative head + principal official adviser + transaction compliance.
- PRODUCTIVE RELATION elected priority → candid options/legality → recorded decision → loyal implementation.
- FAILURE BRANCHES politicised advice
- bureaucratic veto

CHECK / LIMIT
- oral direction
- short tenure
- hidden responsibility.
- ANSWER STRIP

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- Responsive neutrality joins lawful democratic control to professional institutional memory.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Cabinet makes collective political decisions, Cabinet Committees handle delegated political work, and Committees of Secretaries coordinate administration without acquiring ministerial authority Applied here to minister, minister of state and secretary.

04 STAGE 04 — CENTRAL SECRETARIAT FUNCTIONS AND FILE PROCESS

CENTRAL SECRETARIAT FUNCTIONS AND FILE PROCESS · CENTRAL SECRETARIAT POLICY · FILE RAIL RECEIPT · SECTION EXAMINATION · INTER-DEPARTMENT CONSULTATION · DELEGATED OR HIGHER APPROVAL · SECTION OFFICER · UNDER SECRETARY

CENTRAL SECRETARIAT policy → FILE RAIL receipt → section examination → facts/law/finance → noting/options → inter-department consultation → delegated or higher approval → authentication/issue → implementation → monitoring/audit/RTI. → Section Officer → Under Secretary → Deputy Secretary/Director

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- CENTRAL SECRETARIAT policy
- FILE RAIL receipt → section examination → facts/law/finance → noting/options

POWER / PROCEDURE
- inter-department consultation → delegated or higher approval
- authentication/issue → implementation → monitoring/audit/RTI.

CHECK / LIMIT
- Section Officer → Under Secretary → Deputy Secretary/Director
- Joint Secretary → Additional/Special Secretary → Secretary.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- TRAP not every file reaches Minister/Secretary; delegation is an accountability design, not evasion.
- CENTRAL SECRETARIAT policy

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Central Secretariat is the collective policy-support machinery of Union ministries, not a single building and not a synonym for the Cabinet Secretariat Applied here to central secretariat functions and file process.

05 STAGE 05 — SECRETARIAT HIERARCHY AND DELEGATED FILE DISPOSAL

SECRETARY · JOINT SECRETARY / DIVISION · UNDER SECRETARY / SECTION · EXAMINE → CONSULT → APPROVE · LOWEST COMPETENT LEVEL · RECORDED AUTHORITY · ISSUE + AUTHENTICATE · MONITOR + RETAIN

AUTHORITY
- SECRETARY
- JOINT SECRETARY / DIVISION

PROCEDURE
- UNDER SECRETARY / SECTION
- EXAMINE → CONSULT → APPROVE

CHECK
- LOWEST COMPETENT LEVEL
- RECORDED AUTHORITY

OUTCOME
- ISSUE + AUTHENTICATE
- MONITOR + RETAIN

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Secretariat efficiency requires delegated disposal with an authoritative record of competence, consultation, reasons and follow-up Applied here to secretariat hierarchy and delegated file disposal.

06 STAGE 06 — CABINET SECRETARIAT, PMO AND COORDINATION

CABINET SECRETARIAT, PMO AND COORDINATION · CABINET SECRETARIAT · CABINET PAPERS/DECISIONS · AOB-ToB ADMINISTRATION · CRISIS AND CONSENSUS · PMO DIRECT ASSISTANCE TO PRIME MINISTER · PRIORITY REVIEW · MATTERS REQUIRING PM ATTENTION

Cabinet papers/decisions	AoB-ToB administration	CoS	crisis and consensus.
PMO direct assistance to Prime Minister	priority review	matters requiring PM attention.	
Cabinet Secretariat != Cabinet	PMO != super-ministry	Cabinet Secretary != minister.	

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- CABINET SECRETARIAT
- Cabinet papers/decisions
- AoB-ToB administration
- crisis and consensus.

POWER / PROCEDURE
- PMO direct assistance to Prime Minister
- priority review
- matters requiring PM attention.
- UNRESOLVED DIFFERENCE department consultation → Committee of Secretaries → concerned ministers

CHECK / LIMIT
- Cabinet Committee/Cabinet under the prescribed route.
- Cabinet Secretariat != Cabinet
- PMO != super-ministry
- Cabinet Secretary != minister.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- ANSWER STRIP
- Central coordination should enable departments without erasing ministerial answerability.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Over-centralisation in either can weaken departmental initiative; weak central coordination can produce silos and contradictory policies Applied here to cabinet secretariat, pmo and coordination.

07 STAGE 07 — AGENCIES, AUTONOMY AND WHOLE-OF-GOVERNMENT OUTCOMES

AGENCIES, AUTONOMY AND WHOLE-OF-GOVERNMENT OUTCOMES · DEPARTMENTAL POLICY OWNER ATTACHED/SUBORDINATE OFFICE · TECHNICAL/FIELD EXECUTION AUTONOMOUS BODY · CHARTERED SPECIAL FUNCTION · COMMERCIAL/STRATEGIC OPERATION REGULATOR · STATUTE-BASED ARM'S-LENGTH GOVERNANCE · WHOLE-OF-GOVERNMENT PROBLEM CLIMATE/DATA/SKILLS/WATER · MANY DEPARTMENTS

DEPARTMENTAL POLICY OWNER attached/subordinate office → technical/field execution autonomous body → chartered special function

CPSE → commercial/strategic operation regulator → statute-based arm's-length governance · WHOLE-OF-GOVERNMENT PROBLEM climate/data/skills/water → many departments → silo optimisation → outcome failure. → CORRECTIVE named lead + shared milestones/data + funds/functionaries + State/field feedback.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- DEPARTMENTAL POLICY OWNER attached/subordinate office → technical/field execution autonomous body → chartered special function
- CPSE → commercial/strategic operation regulator → statute-based arm's-length governance

POWER / PROCEDURE
- WHOLE-OF-GOVERNMENT PROBLEM climate/data/skills/water → many departments → silo optimisation → outcome failure.
- CORRECTIVE named lead + shared milestones/data + funds/functionaries + State/field feedback.

CHECK / LIMIT
- LIMIT mission unit or dashboard cannot displace statute, sanction, Cabinet route or audit.
- DEPARTMENTAL POLICY OWNER attached/subordinate office → technical/field execution autonomous body → chartered special function

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- CPSE → commercial/strategic operation regulator → statute-based arm's-length governance
- WHOLE-OF-GOVERNMENT PROBLEM climate/data/skills/water → many departments → silo optimisation → outcome failure.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Secretariats primarily formulate and supervise policy while executive agencies deliver it, but delegation never removes departmental stewardship or ministerial accountability Applied here to agencies, autonomy and whole-of-government outcomes.

08 STAGE 08 — OVERSIGHT, REFORM AND NOTIFICATION-SENSITIVE CHANGE

OVERSIGHT, REFORM AND NOTIFICATION-SENSITIVE CHANGE · ACCOUNTABILITY GRID · POLITICAL AND POLICY SCRUTINY. · FINANCIAL LEGALITY, PROPRIETY AND PERFORMANCE. · TRANSPARENCY, LEGALITY AND PERSONAL RESPONSIBILITY · 2ND ARC PRINCIPLES · COMPETENCY-TO-POST FIT · MISSION KARMAYOGI DIGITAL RECORD

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
ACCOUNTABILITY GRID	RTI/courts/vigilance → transparency, legality and personal responsibility.	Mission Karmayogi digital record	specialist/lateral support.
Parliament/questions/DRSCs → political and policy scrutiny.	2nd ARC principles	impact evaluation	Article 77(3) rule change → cadres/budgets/records/contracts/statutory references transition.
budget/demands/CAG/PAC → financial legality, propriety and performance.	competency-to-post fit	stable tenure	TRAP renamed organogram != improved outcome; ministry/committee counts must be dated.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- ACCOUNTABILITY GRID
- Parliament/questions/DRSCs → political and policy scrutiny.
- budget/demands/CAG/PAC → financial legality, propriety and performance.

POWER / PROCEDURE
- RTI/courts/vigilance → transparency, legality and personal responsibility.
- 2nd ARC principles
- competency-to-post fit

CHECK / LIMIT
- Mission Karmayogi digital record
- impact evaluation
- stable tenure

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- specialist/lateral support.
- Article 77(3) rule change → cadres/budgets/records/contracts/statutory references transition.
- TRAP renamed organogram != improved outcome; ministry/committee counts must be dated.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Article 77(3) rule change → cadres/budgets/records/contracts/statutory references transition.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Preserve institutional balance: coordination by Cabinet Secretariat/PMO must enable, not erase, ministerial responsibility and departmental expertise Applied here to oversight, reform and notification-sensitive change.

09 STAGE 09 — CABINET COMMITTEES AND INTER-MINISTERIAL RESOLUTION

CABINET · CABINET COMMITTEES · COMMITTEES OF SECRETARIES · CABINET SECRETARIAT · PMO SUPPORTS PM · POLITICAL + ADMINISTRATIVE BODY · ESCALATE REAL CONFLICT · PRESERVE MINISTERIAL ANSWERABILITY

AUTHORITY
- CABINET
- CABINET COMMITTEES

PROCEDURE
- COMMITTEES OF SECRETARIES
- CABINET SECRETARIAT

CHECK
- PMO SUPPORTS PM
- POLITICAL + ADMINISTRATIVE BODY

OUTCOME
- ESCALATE REAL CONFLICT
- PRESERVE MINISTERIAL ANSWERABILITY

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Centre-of-government coordination should resolve cross-ministry conflict without erasing departmental competence or ministerial responsibility Applied here to cabinet committees and inter-ministerial resolution.

10 STAGE 10 — VERIFIED PYQS AND ANSWER EXECUTION

2025 PAIRS: NONE · 2020 INSTITUTIONAL QUALITY · 2020 E-GOVERNANCE · 2024 CABINET GROWTH: · EXACT DIRECTIVE · NAMED RULE OR ARTICLE · MECHANISM + ACCOUNTABILITY · QUALIFIED REFORM VERDICT

AUTHORITY
- 2025 PAIRS: NONE
- 2020 INSTITUTIONAL QUALITY

PROCEDURE
- 2020 E-GOVERNANCE
- 2024 CABINET GROWTH

CHECK
- EXACT DIRECTIVE
- NAMED RULE OR ARTICLE

OUTCOME
- MECHANISM + ACCOUNTABILITY
- QUALIFIED REFORM VERDICT

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: A high-scoring answer connects constitutional source, organisational mechanism, accountability consequence and executable reform Applied here to verified pyqs and answer execution.

11 STAGE 11 — UPSC SYNTHESIS: ORGANISED AUTHORITY WITH TRACEABLE RESPONSIBILITY

UPSC SYNTHESIS · ORGANISED AUTHORITY WITH TRACEABLE RESPONSIBILITY · PRELIMS FIREWALL · PRESIDENT'S NAME · PERSONAL DECISION · CABINET SECRETARIAT · CABINET COMMITTEE · COMMITTEE OF SECRETARIES ATTACHED OFFICE

PRELIMS FIREWALL → President's name != personal decision → Secretariat != Cabinet Secretariat → Cabinet Committee != Committee of Secretaries attached office != autonomous body → regulator autonomy survives ordinary instruction.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- PRELIMS FIREWALL
- President's name != personal decision
- Secretariat != Cabinet Secretariat

POWER / PROCEDURE
- Cabinet Committee != Committee of Secretaries attached office != autonomous body
- regulator autonomy survives ordinary instruction.
- MAINS SPINE

CHECK / LIMIT
- Articles 73/74/77/78 → AoB-ToB → ministry/department
- Minister-Secretary → Secretariat/file → coordination
- agencies/outcomes → oversight → reform.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- PYQ SPINE
- 2025 organisation-ministry pairs → verify allocated subject and parent law.
- VERDICT effective machinery aligns functions, funds, functionaries, expertise and answerability.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Executive action is taken in the President's name, but the President does not personally administer each department Applied here to upsc synthesis: organised authority with traceable responsibility.

E EXTRA — SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT! · THE PRINCIPAL DELEGATES AUTHORITY · THE AGENT POSSESSES INFORMATION THE PRINCIPAL MAY LACK · MONITORING IS INCOMPLETE; AND · RESPONSIBILITY CAN BE SHIFTED DOWN OR SIDEWAYS. · ADVERSE SELECTION · APPOINTING AN AGENT WITHOUT KNOWING CAPABILITY/INTEGRITY · MORAL HAZARD

OPTIONAL DOCTRINE / CASE
- the principal delegates authority;
- the agent possesses information the principal may lack;
- monitoring is incomplete; and
- responsibility can be shifted down or sideways.

ADVANCED LIMIT
- adverse selection: appointing an agent without knowing capability/integrity;
- moral hazard: agent acts differently after receiving discretion;
- information asymmetry: ministry/agency knows more than Parliament/citizen;
- multiple principals: an agency answers to ministry, finance, regulator, court and legislature;

COMPARATIVE NUANCE
- blame avoidance: success is claimed centrally while failure is attributed to field offices.
- Minister states objectives, political priorities and acceptable trade-offs.
- Secretary supplies options, legality, evidence, implementation constraints and institutional
- Disagreement is recorded professionally.

OPTIONAL STATUS — *This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.*

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels